THE GRINLIFE LANTERN TRAIL

A big vision, built one safe step at a time.

A feature-preserving delivery roadmap for a single GrinLife platform that brings together meaningful connection, consent-led chance encounters, and protected family memories.

CONNECT
Intentional matching, messages, groups, and journeys.

CHANCE
Consent-led encounters, timers, exits, and reconnection.

LEGACY
Secure vault, stories, family care, and keepsakes.

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Contents

1 Executive direction

GrinLife is the unified platform for the previously separate GrinSocial, GrinLuck, and Grinrex Legacy concepts. It retains the three experiences as distinct private doors—**Connect**, **Chance**, and **Legacy**—but builds identity, consent, safety, data stewardship, notifications, and operational controls once. The roadmap does **not** remove any original feature. Every capability is retained in a registry, assigned an owner and permission model, and released only when its evidence gate passes.

> **Operating principle:** preserve the full vision, but expose only the next trustworthy user loop. A rich roadmap is not a license to release an unfinished sensitive feature.

DOOR 1 **Connect**

Preference-led discovery, matching, messaging, groups, and journeys are introduced behind one safety service.

DOOR 2 **Chance**

Roll, Spark, timed Talk, mutual Choose, fast exit, and later rituals remain deliberately consent-led and cohort controlled.

DOOR 3 **Legacy**

A secure vault comes before AI, family access, inheritance, physical keepsakes, and provenance.

1.1 Program outcome and duration

The program is expected to take approximately **18–30 months** for a mature complete version, depending on team capacity, backend readiness, compliance scope, and the complexity of physical commerce. A useful beta can arrive earlier after the shared foundation and the first Connect loop have proved safe and operational.

Phase	Lantern stop	Duration	Release outcome
0	Program setup	2–4 weeks	Approved feature map, architecture direction, controls, and delivery governance.
1	Shared foundation	6–8 weeks	Identity, permission, safety, analytics, deployment, and recovery foundations.
2	Connect MVP	8–12 weeks	A controlled, instrumented matching and messaging loop.
3	Chance MVP	8–12 weeks	A consent-led timed encounter loop with safety and reconnection.
4	Connect expansion	8–12 weeks	Groups, journeys, preference evolution, and growth foundations.
5	Legacy Vault MVP	10–16 weeks	Encrypted memories, organization, search, export, deletion, and recovery.
6	Legacy AI	8–14 weeks	Traceable AI-assisted organization and storytelling.
7	Family and inheritance	10–16 weeks	Controlled collaboration, trusted contacts, stateful inheritance, and auditability.
8	Physical Legacy	10–16 weeks	Approved-asset commerce, fulfilment, support, and provenance.

Phase	Lantern stop	Duration	Release outcome
9	Scale and global release	10–20 weeks	Pricing, enterprise, multilingual operations, partners, and reliability at scale.

2 The ten-lantern delivery path

Each lantern holds a single accountable release step. The phase cannot advance merely because its interface exists; it must show the proof described below.

0

BASE CAMP **Program setup and product inventory**

Create the GrinLife feature registry; classify data; map source systems, vendors, and product boundaries; reproduce deployment issues; agree decision rights; and record every original Connect, Chance, and Legacy capability.

1

BASE CAMP **Shared foundation**

Ship account creation, recovery, eligibility, module-scoped permissions, consent, privacy, reporting, blocking, audit events, backups, restore drills, real routes, and observable deployment. No product module can work around these controls.

2

CONNECT **Connect controlled beta**

Deliver preference onboarding, understandable matching, messages, leave/block/report, coarse location, manual moderation, accessibility support, and measured retention. Exit only after the team can resolve real safety cases.

3

CHANCE **Chance controlled beta**

Deliver adult-eligible pools, Roll, Spark, server-authoritative Talk, mutual Choose, fast exit, reconnect, consent withdrawal, density controls, and adversarial-abuse defenses. Later rituals remain feature-flagged.

4

CONNECT **Connect expansion**

Add groups, group roles, journeys, moderation, preference-impact previews, and grace periods only after safety capacity, fair recommendation controls, and group evidence meet the defined threshold.

5

LEGACY **Legacy Vault**

Open a private-by-default vault for scanned, quarantined, encrypted uploads; collections; tags; basic search; downloads; export; deletion; access logs; backup restoration; and key rotation.

6

LEGACY **AI assistance and storytelling**

Add permission-aware tagging, OCR, transcription, semantic search, editable story drafts, provenance, labels, cost controls, retry states, and deletion propagation under managed model and prompt releases.

7

LEGACY **Family and inheritance**

Introduce invitations, roles, shared collections, trusted contacts, time capsules, verification, cancellation, dispute management, third-party rights, and auditable high-impact state transitions.

8

LEGACY **Physical Legacy and provenance**

Allow a customer to select only approved assets for an order workspace with pricing, payment, revision, cancellation, refund, fulfilment, support, and privacy-preserving provenance.

9

ALL THREE DOORS **Scale, monetization, and global operations**

Expand premium plans, referrals, enterprise controls, partnerships, languages, regions, and operating capacity only after product, safety, support, and reliability proof remain healthy at the larger scale.

3 First-pass audit: foundational blockers and corrective controls

The first audit identified the gap between the three public product narratives and a secure, operational unified product. The response is a modular monolith with explicit Identity, Consent, Safety, Connect, Chance, Legacy Assets, AI and Search, Family and Inheritance, Commerce, and Operations domains. Shared identity never implies shared profile exposure; Legacy assets and derived AI metadata stay outside social and chance discovery indexes by default.

Blocker	Corrective control	Release proof
No canonical product boundary	Build one modular application with real authenticated routes, loading/error states, contracts, and monitored APIs.	A test user registers, manages settings, enters the app shell, and API requests are observable.
Cross-module privacy leakage	Use deny-by-default module entitlements and explicit, versioned sharing consent.	Authorization tests prove Connect and Chance identities cannot read private Legacy assets or family roles.
Safety is not operational	Run one staffed report/block/moderation service with severity, case history, appeals, and incident playbooks.	Reports create case IDs; blocks act immediately; moderator actions and escalation drills are audit logged.

Blocker	Corrective control	Release proof
Chance cold start and unsafe pools	Use cohort windows, safe waiting rooms, eligibility, visibility preview, timers, reconnect, density fallback, and feature flags.	Concurrent, timer, low-density, report/block, and consent-withdrawal simulations pass.
Legacy governance gap	Use encrypted storage, asset ACLs, scanning, export/delete, retention, access events, and separate AI-derived data policy.	A user can upload, export, delete, revoke access, and verify deletion propagation.
Inheritance released too early	Treat inheritance as reversible, reviewed state transitions—not a checkbox or legal-will claim.	Revocation, mistaken trigger, conflict, compromise, verification, and escalation tests pass.
AI lacks provenance and controls	Use permission-aware orchestration with sources, labels, editable output, retry, budget, and deletion handling.	Every output identifies sources, respects ACLs, can be edited/deleted, and stays within a cost ceiling.
Commerce distracts from trust	Release approved-asset ordering only after vault governance is proven; retain blockchain as optional evidence, never private storage.	Orders can be quoted, paid, fulfilled, cancelled, refunded, and supported without broad vault access.
Deployment and conversion gaps	Replace placeholder CTAs; add legal routes, clean-session, hard-reload, mobile, slow-network, direct-link, and rollback tests.	No primary placeholder remains and release smoke tests pass.

4 Second-pass audit: residual release blockers

The second pass tests the remediation plan against compromised accounts, hidden data flows, human safety operations, vendor and model changes, fragile recovery, and launch pressure. These controls are additive; no original product capability is removed.

4.1 P0 — controls that block exposure

Residual blocker	Additive corrective action	Required proof
Account recovery	Make recovery a state machine with step-up checks, cooling periods, notices, history, and manual review for high-risk changes.	Compromise, device-loss, impersonation, cancellation, and sensitive-change pause tests pass.
Age and audience policy	Use a country and module age matrix; keep initial Chance beta adult-only; separate age assurance from identity display.	Ineligible people cannot enter restricted flows or receive restricted notices.

Residual blocker	Additive corrective action	Required proof
Deletion and derived-data conflict	Maintain a lifecycle registry and deletion orchestration for originals, indexes, embeddings, caches, exports, backups, and legitimate exceptions.	Representative vault, conversation, report, and AI story deletion traces pass.
Consent drift	Use versioned consent ledger and code-level policy checks for every data-read route, job, and event.	Automated policy tests fail any scoped access without a valid decision.
Safety capacity	Operate staffed triage, severity, response targets, victim language, appeals separation, QA, and incident learning.	Tabletop and live urgent-report drills meet the stated response target.
Chance adversarial abuse	Add risk scoring, integrity signals, velocity/graph limits, cooldowns, repeat-pair avoidance, controls, and human review.	Farming, scripts, harassment, timer manipulation, and report-evasion simulations show measured outcomes.
Legacy ingestion trust	Quarantine files; validate/scan/strip metadata; isolate originals until checks and permissions complete; use short-lived retrieval.	Malicious, malformed, oversized, duplicate, and interrupted uploads are rejected or safely isolated.
Key recovery and rotation	Define key hierarchy, boundaries, rotation, revocation, hardware-backed secrets, recovery escrow, and a compromise playbook.	A key-rotation and compromise exercise completes without unauthorized reads or data loss.

4.2 P1 — controls that prevent silent drift

Residual blocker	Additive corrective action	Required proof
AI provider lifecycle	Register providers, models, prompts, retrieval sources, retention, evaluations, pinned releases, fallbacks, and rollback.	A provider/model change is traceable, evaluated, explainable, and reversible.
People inside memories	Separate uploader control from person-in-content safeguards; offer labels, granular sharing, redaction, objection, and minor policy.	A third-party dispute proves review, redaction, appeal, and audit behavior.
Matching fairness	Set permitted signals, exposure caps, explanations, editing, outcome monitoring, and fairness reviews.	Inputs, outcome slices, repeated exposure, controls, and corrective thresholds are documented.
Analytics data blending	Use a privacy-scoped taxonomy; forbid raw Legacy content, unnecessary text, precise location, and sensitive reports.	Schema reviews and tests reject, redact, or aggregate restricted fields.

Residual blocker	Additive corrective action	Required proof
Vendor access	Maintain processors, data flows, least privilege, security terms, kill switches, and offboarding; vendors see only approved assets.	Every processor has purpose, scope, retention, owner, review date, and exit plan.
Feature flag bypass	Classify flags and require owner, expiry, cohort, consent dependency, rollback, and monitoring; flags never replace policy checks.	Cohort changes cannot bypass permissions, consent, age policy, or release evidence.
Migration and identity linking	Define merge, separation, import, provenance, preview, undo, and dispute procedures.	Duplicate, shared-device, contested-archive, wrong-email, and reverse-merge cases have clean audit trails.
Inclusion and localization	Define keyboard, screen-reader, captions, simple-language, low-bandwidth, time-control, translated-text, and RTL readiness.	Assistive-technology, reduced-motion, slow-network, expansion, and time-control tests pass.
Release governance	Create a release council with no-go conditions, risk acceptance expiry, rollback authority, and communication templates.	A simulated no-go and rollback demonstrate unambiguous decision rights.

5 Sequence amendments and release evidence

5.1 Eight sub-gates that move controls earlier

Gate	Insert before	Mandatory deliverable
0A	Shared foundation	Data-lifecycle registry, processor register, system-of-record map, and cross-module analytics ban list.
0B	Shared foundation	Threat model, recovery state machine, compromise runbook, key plan, and incident ownership.
1A	Connect beta	Age matrix, cohort policy, moderator capacity, severity taxonomy, response targets, and appeals design.
1B	Connect beta	Consent ledger, policy-enforced access, analytics review, and end-to-end deletion trace.
5A	Legacy vault beta	Upload quarantine, scanning, signed retrieval, key rotation, restore, and deletion propagation drills.
6A	AI beta	Model/provider/prompt registry, retained-data policy, evaluation suite, budget caps, provenance, and rollback.
7A	Family/inheritance beta	Third-party content policy, dispute path, living-person restrictions, jurisdiction review, and state-machine rehearsal.

Gate	Insert before	Mandatory deliverable
8A	Commerce beta	Approved-asset order workspace, vendor scope, processor terms, cancellation/refund, and production-asset deletion.

5.2 Minimum evidence dashboard

Evidence area	Minimum question	Automatic release rule
Permissions	Can a user, service, job, or event access only authorized data?	A failing authorization or consent test is a no-go.
Account safety	Can an attacker or mistaken support workflow take over a sensitive state?	High-impact recovery and family paths require independent review and cooldown evidence.
Human safety	Who receives a report, what happens, and how quickly can harm be reduced?	No social beta without staffed triage, escalation, and user communication.
Data lifecycle	Can data be traced through collection, sharing, processing, deletion, and backup expiry?	No sensitive vault or AI beta without a tested lifecycle trace.
AI integrity	Can the system show sources, keep permissions, limit cost, and roll back behavior?	No AI beta without provenance, evaluation, and rollback proof.
Reliability	Can the product handle slow networks, direct links, failed jobs, restart, and rollback?	No cohort expansion without recovery and failure-injection evidence.
Inclusion	Can intended people complete the workflow with assistive technology, low bandwidth, and language needs?	Accessibility or localization blockers stop the affected release.
Governance	Who can say no, accept residual risk, and stop a release?	Recorded sign-off, expiry, and rollback authority are mandatory.

6 Corrected strict implementation order

1	Map and decide	Inventory retained features, data, vendors, risks, ownership, source systems, and decision rights.
2	Secure identity and recovery	Build authentication, eligibility, recovery state machine, compromise response, consent ledger, and enforced permissions.
3	Operate safety and lifecycle	Staff triage, define reports/appeals, test deletion/backups, restrict analytics, and manage keys and incidents.

4	Connect closed beta	Validate introductions, messaging, leave/block/report, moderation, accessibility, and a limited cohort.
5	Chance controlled beta	Validate pools, consent, timers, exits, reconnect, adversarial defenses, and density safeguards.
6	Expand Connect carefully	Add groups and journeys only after moderation capacity, recommendation controls, and group safety proof.
7	Open the Legacy vault	Prove ingestion, encryption, asset permissions, export, deletion, key rotation, and disaster recovery.
8	Add AI assistance	Use traceable, editable, permission-aware AI only under provider/prompt change controls and cost limits.
9	Enable family and inheritance	Add collaboration, third-party protections, and high-impact state flows after dispute, jurisdiction, and recovery simulations.
10	Add keepsakes and scale	Introduce commerce, provenance, pricing, enterprise, languages, and regions only after vendor and operating capacity evidence.

7 Operating model: owners, transition, and first 90 days

7.1 Accountable teams

PLATFORM **Shared trust infrastructure**

Identity, recovery, permissions, consent, audit events, notifications, analytics, deployment, storage foundation, backups, and restore evidence.

CONNECT + CHANCE **Social product and safety**

Preferences, matching, messages, groups, pools, prompts, timed encounters, density, retention, and shared moderation evidence.

LEGACY + AI **Private assets and assisted storytelling**

Vault assets, timelines, AI outputs, provenance, family roles, inheritance controls, source traceability, and deletion propagation.

OPS + COMMERCE **Reliability and fulfilment**

Release checks, vendors, payments, physical orders, refunds, support, enterprise readiness, and operational capacity.

7.2 Original brand transition

The existing project URLs remain active during the transition and route people into the appropriate GrinLife experience: GrinLuck to `/chance`, GrinSocial to `/connect`, and Grinrex Legacy to `/legacy`. Marketing and assets move first. Any hidden user data requires identity mapping, consent reconciliation, duplicate-account handling, import testing, and rollback planning before production traffic changes.

7.3 First 90 days

Time	Outcome	Work that must finish
Days 1–15	One authoritative product plan	Feature registry; code/data/analytics and vendor inventory; classification; deployment incident reproduction; policy gaps; module boundaries; decision rights.
Days 16–45	Trustworthy shared foundation	Authentication, recovery/deletion, privacy center, reporting/blocking, audit history, feature flags, monitoring, taxonomy, CI/CD, restore drill, and real routes.
Days 46–75	Testable Connect beta	Preferences, controlled matches, messaging, leave/block/report, coarse location, moderation queue, instrumentation, and invitation cohort workflow.
Days 76–90	Evidence for the next module	Validate Connect safety/retention; run Chance spike and safety simulations; begin Legacy asset/permission design without exposing inheritance or commerce.

7.4 Release-state discipline

Every retained feature carries an explicit state: **planned**, **internal**, **alpha**, **beta**, **limited**, **general**, or **paused**. Advanced Chance rituals, referral and premium systems, AI biography, face recognition, family trees, trusted contacts, time capsules, inheritance execution, provenance, physical products, enterprise, partners, and global expansion stay preserved and feature-flagged until their relevant evidence gates pass.

8 Final recommendation

GrinLife should begin with a shared identity, privacy, safety, and operations foundation; prove one Connect loop; then introduce Chance and the Legacy vault in dependency order. The most important product quality is not the number of screens released. It is **operational integrity** when an account is compromised, a person needs safety help, a family disputes a memory, a model changes, a vendor sees data, or launch pressure rises. The roadmap retains the entire original vision while making those failure cases concrete design and release requirements.

9 References

[1] GrinLuck deployed project
[2] GrinSocial deployed project
[3] Grinrex Legacy deployed project
Internal source records: **GrinLife Phase-Wise Roadmap**, **GrinLife Product Gap Audit and Feature-Preserving Solution Plan**, and **GrinLife Second-Pass Product Audit**.